Key Factors in Change

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Written by: Lisa Eades
Reviewed by: Steve Vorster
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An introduction to change management

- Effective **change management** involves identifying, organising and implementing new methods of working in a business
- Several factors will have an impact on **how a successful change can be implemented**

Factors affecting business change

Factors affecting business change include organisational culture and size, the pace of change and the level of resistance to change

Organisational culture

- To successfully implement change, leaders must understand the **culture** of their organisation and **work to align it with the desired change**
- The way **employees and leaders perceive change** and their willingness to embrace it can be heavily influenced by the organisational culture within a business
  - If the culture is one of routine and predictability, employees may be hesitant to embrace new processes and procedures
  - An innovative and flexible culture may mean that employees are more receptive to change
- How effectively **change is communicated** to employees is related to a business's culture

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

limited, and information may not be easily accessible to all employees

- A **strong organisational culture** can support employee engagement and ownership of change
  - When employees feel valued and are part of a supportive culture, they are more likely to embrace change and work together to implement it successfully

- Organisational culture can affect the **adaptability of a business**
  - A culture that values continuous learning and improvement is more likely to adapt quickly to changes in the external environment
  - A culture that is resistant to change may struggle to adapt to new circumstances

Help me understand

Size of the organisation

- The size of a business can affect its ability to implement change
  - Larger organisations usually have **complex structures**, which can make change more difficult to implement
  - Communication is often more challenging due to the sheer **number of people involved**

- The larger the organisation, the **more difficult it can be to communicate change** effectively and ensure that everyone is on the same page
  - Larger organisations may have complex decision-making processes that can slow down the implementation of change
  - With more layers of **hierarchy**, there may be more people involved in decision-making, which can **lead to delays**
  - There may be many people who are resistant to change, and it can be more difficult to address their various concerns

- Larger businesses often have **more resources available to support change** initiatives, such as financial resources, technology and **experienced staff**

Pace of change

- It's important to find a pace for change that is **appropriate for the situation** and which takes into account the needs and concerns of all **stakeholders** involved
- If the pace of change is **too fast**:
  - It can create resistance from overwhelmed workers who feel unprepared and that they don't have enough time to adjust
  - It may **not be properly thought through** or planned, resulting in poor execution

- **If the pace of change is too slow**, it can result in:
  - A lack of adaptability and **innovation**
  - A loss of momentum, leading to delays or even the abandonment of the change
  - Communication efforts becoming stagnant, leading to disinterest and disengagement

Resistance to change

- Businesses attempting to implement change are likely to face **resistance** from a range of **stakeholders**

Stakeholder resistance to change

Stakeholder	Reasons for resistance
Employees	• Employees may worry about how the change will affect their **job security** or **work environment** • Employees may not understand **why the change is needed** or what the **expected outcomes** are • Employees may be used to **doing things a certain way** and may be reluctant to learn new skills
Owners	• Owners may fear that changing their current processes may cause disruption to their daily operations and affect **productivity** • Owners may be reluctant to agree to these costs, especially if they involve a **personal, financial or time commitment** • They may prefer to **maintain the status quo** rather than take risks that could potentially harm their business • They may not fully **understand the benefits** of the proposed changes or lack the knowledge or expertise to implement them effectively

Customers	• Customers may be **hesitant to try something new** or unfamiliar
	  ○ Changing to something new can be **uncomfortable** or even intimidating
	  ○ Customers may fear **losing something they value**
	  ▪ For example, if a new product or service replaces an existing one, customers may worry that the new one won't be as good as the old one or that they will lose features they like
	• Sometimes, customers may simply be **used to buying certain products** or

Suppliers	• Suppliers may be reluctant to **change their processes or systems**
	  ○ They may be worried that the change will lead to a decrease in **quality** or **additional costs**
	  ○ They may have **invested a significant amount of time, money and resources** in their current systems so are hesitant to abandon them
	  ○ Suppliers may not have the **necessary expertise or knowledge** to implement new systems or processes

Managing resistance to change

- Managing resistance to change requires a thoughtful and **strategic approach** that takes into account the concerns of key **stakeholders**
- Clear communication is **essential** when introducing change in a business:
  - The reasons behind the change and the **benefits that the change will bring** must be communicated
  - The change must be communicated in **multiple ways**, such as emails, meetings, presentations and one-on-one conversations
- **Involving stakeholders** in the change process can help to build buy-in and support for the change
  - Employees who are involved in the process are more likely to embrace the change and feel a sense of ownership over it
  - Open dialogue and feedback throughout the process with all key **stakeholders** is essential
- Providing **training and support** will help employees adapt to the new changes and learn new skills and technologies
- Identifying and **addressing stakeholder concerns** is vital
- **Realistic expectations** about the change should be set
- Successes and milestones should be **celebrated along the way**

Examiner Tips and Tricks

Try to consider the following when answering questions about organisational change:

- What is driving the need for change? Internal factors? External factors?
- How is the change to be implemented?
- What outcome is expected or hoped for as a result of the change?

All of these questions should be answered with **explicit reference to the scenario provided**. Every organisation approaches, implements and experiences change in different ways as a result of the unique set of influencing factors it faces.

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